

Conference Information Pack

13 October 08:00 UTC to 14 October 09:15 UTC

Table of contents

All of the headings below are clickable links

Table of contents	1
Information about the conference	3
Membership	3
Code of conduct	3
Where to go for help	3
How to attend sessions	3
Add your pronouns to your Zoom name	4
Access the program and session information	4
Slack Workspace	4
Tips for non-native English speakers	6
Share your thoughts on social media	6
After the conference	6
Program	8
Special session information	9
Conference Opening Remarks	9
Conference Closing Remarks & Awards Announcing	9
Introductions to Open Science Practices: The 'what', 'why', and 'how' of open science	9
Social Breaks	9
Plenary information	11
Plenary Talk by Lauren Cadwallader: Code sharing in practice: lessons from expanding a publisher's policy	11
Plenary Talk by Tatsuya Amano: Is science open across languages	11
Unconference information	12
U01: A decade of FAIR data in ecology and evolutionary biology— but, what is FAIR?	12
U02: (Yet another) definition of reproducibility and replicability	12
U03: Preregistration in theory and practice – reflections from psychology and health care research	13
U04: Piloting transparency in ecology and evolution: current practices and ways forward	13
U05: Open scholarship through the lens of ecological diversity	14
Hackathon information	15
H01: How does data and code policy impact quality of data and code sharing in society journals?	15



H02: Better crediting of research contributions through improved acknowledgment sections	15
H03 (Cancelled): Open science in ecology: a community hackathon on data & code transparency	16
H04: Prodding societies in ecology and evolution towards greater equity of their membership fee structures: a meta-research protocol	16
H05: Exploring the fidelity of open code to methods descriptions	16
Workshop information	18
W01: Boosting collaborative research with "GitHub flow" for Rstudio users	18
W02: Is your code bug-free? Introduction to test-driven development for ecology and evolution	19
W04: An introduction to using Docker with R for reproducible research	19
Sponsors	21
Acknowledgments	22



Information about the conference

Membership

We encourage attendees to become members of the society: <https://www.sortee.org/join/>.

Code of conduct

All participants are expected to follow the SORTEE code of conduct, so please read it before attending: <https://www.sortee.org/codeofconduct/>.

When speaking, please make an effort to use each other's names and respect people's pronouns.

Since we are connecting remotely and have participants from around the world, please speak slowly and clearly so that everyone can follow along. Please articulate your words clearly, as this will help ensure that all participants can understand you.

If you would like to participate during a session, please use the 'Raise Hand' function in Zoom and wait for the session facilitator to call on you. Alternatively, you can write your thoughts and questions in the Zoom chat and wait for facilitators to read them.

Where to go for help

If you encounter technical difficulties during the conference, please post in the [#conf2026-technical-assistance](#) Slack channel. You can also directly contact the technical assistants assigned to the session you are attending. Their names are listed in the detailed session information in our [program app](#) when you click on the session title. You can contact them by direct message on Slack, or through Zoom. See our [Slack pro tips](#) for instructions on sending direct messages on Slack.

In the event of a major problem (e.g., the whole Zoom meeting has crashed), please be patient and check for emails from Humanitix or messages on the SORTEE Slack channel [#conference2026](#).

Lastly, if someone makes you or anyone else feel unsafe or unwelcome, or you believe a harassment problem exists, please report it as soon as possible to a technical assistant by direct messages on Slack, or on Zoom. Alternatively, you may [report your concerns electronically](#), with the option to remain anonymous.

How to attend sessions

The conference will run non-stop between Tues, Oct 13, 08:00 AM UTC and Wed, Oct 14, 10:00 AM UTC using the same Zoom link:



Zoom link for the entire SORTEE Conference

<https://us06web.zoom.us/j/89981758805?pwd=xfdnTr44EnmmovgguxqMaLaihebai.1>

Meeting ID: 899 8175 8805
Passcode: SORTEE



Add your pronouns to your Zoom name

We encourage participants to add their pronouns to their Zoom display name to help others know how to address them. You can add, remove, or manage your pronouns in Zoom by following [Zoom's instructions here](#).

Access the program and session information

Visualise the program and all session information using our Shiny app:



<https://conf-sortee.shinyapps.io/2026-program-app/>

The program is in [Coordinated Universal Time \(UTC\)](#) by default. The app allows you to **convert the program in your local time zone**. On the top of the app, use the dropdown list to select your city / region. It will convert the program in your local time zone and you can export the converted program in pdf, csv, or excel!

You can also **access all session information on the app**: session topic, outline, audience, and technical assistance assigned to that session, as well as the link to the session Slack channel (and, for certain sessions, the link to their GitHub repository to download materials). Just click on any session to access its information.

In the current document, you can also access [session information](#) and the [program](#).

Slack Workspace



We use Slack to coordinate the conference and facilitate discussions for all sessions during and after the conference. Below, you will find information on how to use Slack.

We recommend joining the three main channels, as well as the session-specific channels that interest you.

Main channels

You can either follow the links or manually add them as described in the next subsection '[Adding Channels](#)'.

- [#conference2026](#) – This is the main channel for conference announcements.
- [#welcome](#) – You can use this channel to introduce yourself to the group.
- [#conf2026-technical-assistance](#) – You can use this channel to ask for help with any technical issues.

Session-specific channels

Conference channels related to specific sessions (plenaries, unconferences, hackathons and workshops) will have the prefix [#conf2026](#) followed by the session name (e.g. [#conf2026-h01-how-data-code-policy-impact-data-quality-code-sharing-in-journals](#)).

The session-specific channels will be used for discussions, asking questions, and sharing resources, and they will remain active even after the conference ends.



If you are interested in **participating in a session but are unable to attend**, we recommend joining the session-specific Slack channel. There, you can express your interest, stay involved in the discussion, access resources, and contribute to any outputs.

Join or access the SORTEE Slack

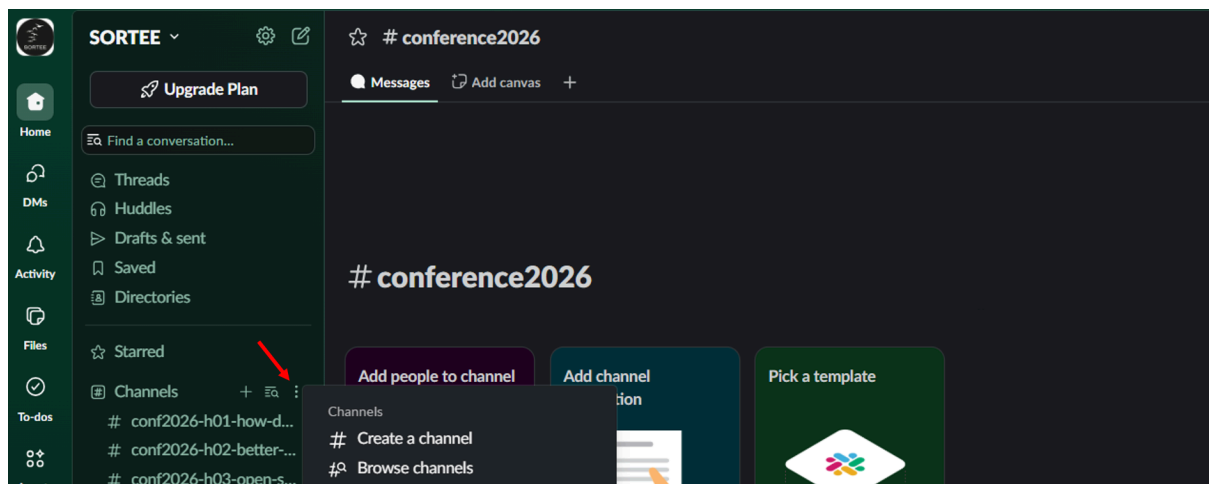
- Not a member yet? [Click here to join](#).
- Already a member? Access the workspace [here](#).
- You can use Slack on both desktop and browser, but for better access, we recommend downloading the desktop app.

New to Slack?

- Watch this [quick introduction to Slack](#).

Adding Channels

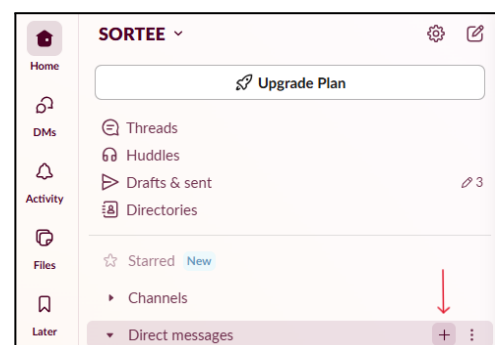
On your left panel, find and hover over 'Channels' and click the three vertical dots on the right (see the red arrow on the figure below). Select 'Browse channels'. Look for the channel you want, hover over it, and click 'Join'.



Slack pro tips

Note: Some tips may only work on the Slack desktop app.

1. *Star important channels.* Starring channels keep them at the top of your list. Right-click on the channel name and select 'Star channel'.
2. *Pause notifications.* Right-click on a channel, hover over 'More options' and then you will find different settings to temporarily mute the channel. To pause notifications for the whole workspace, click on your avatar in the bottom left-hand corner, hover 'Notifications' and choose for how long you want to pause the notifications.
3. *Send direct messages.* On your left panel, below 'Channels', hover over 'Direct messages' and click on the + button (see figure on the right). Start typing the name of the attendee you want to message.





4. *Update your profile.* Click on your avatar in the bottom left-hand corner and select 'Profile'. You can add a picture, your email address, how to pronounce your name, your pronouns, etc.

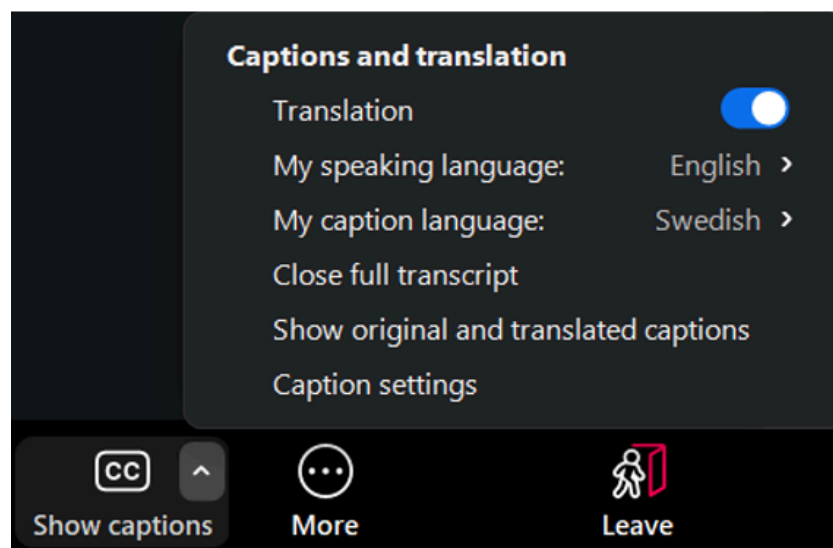
Tips for non-native English speakers

We welcome participation from all attendees, regardless of their level of English proficiency. If you don't feel comfortable speaking, you can share your thoughts and questions in the chat, and the session facilitators will read them out loud for you.

Please note that none of the sessions are recorded. The only recorded parts are the two 40-minute plenary talks. The following 20-minute question times are not recorded.

Automated captions and translations

The automated captions function will be available throughout the conference. You can access this feature by clicking the 'Show captions' button on the lower Zoom taskbar (see the figure below - if you don't see it, click 'More' to find it). If you click on the arrow, you can activate the translation button to automatically translate the captions into any language provided by Zoom. Simply click on "My caption language" and select your language from the list. Please note that the language spoken throughout the conference will be English; therefore, keep the 'My speaking language' option set to English to ensure smooth translation.



Share your thoughts on social media

Are you using social media? We would love to hear your experiences and catch up on what happened in different timezones, through the **#SORTEE2026** hashtag. Find us on [Mastodon](#), [Bluesky](#), [Instagram](#), and [LinkedIn](#). Be sure to tag us 😊

After the conference

Feedback

Please share your feedback in this [short anonymous survey](#). We are eager to get your feedback as we will soon start planning the 2027 SORTEE conference. Thank you in advance!



SORTEE Slack

Stay on the SORTEE Slack! The Slack workspace is for the whole SORTEE community, not just those who joined us for the conference, and it will stay active after the conference ends. You will still be able to access the conference channels to continue your discussions and access and share resources. Note that messages disappear after 90 days, so if there are resources you want to keep please download/bookmark them before then.

Stay tuned

Subscribe to the [SORTEE conference mailing list](#) and receive SORTEE 2027 conference updates. We send approximately 8 emails a year.

Plenary recordings

The two plenary talks will be available shortly after the conference on the [SORTEE Youtube channel](#).

GitHub repository

Use the SORTEE Conference GitHub repository ([sortee-2026](#)) to access slides and materials of the conference.



Program

You can find the program below or access it on our program app at <https://conf-sortee.shinyapps.io/2026-program-app/>.

The program below is in Coordinated Universal Time (UTC).

PROGRAM - SORTEE Conference 2026			
UTC Time Zone			
Day	Start Time	End Time	Program
10-13	08:00	08:15	Conference opening
10-13	08:15	09:00	Introduction to Open Science Practices: The 'what', 'why', and 'how' of open science
10-13	09:00	10:25	Hackathon 1: How does data and code policy impact quality of data and code sharing in society journals?
10-13	10:30	11:30	Unconference 1: A decade of FAIR data in ecology and evolutionary biology – but, what is FAIR?
10-13	11:30	11:55	Break 1: Social break – career stages breakout groups
10-13	12:00	12:55	Plenary Talk 1: Code sharing in practice: lessons from expanding a publisher's policy
10-13	13:00	13:55	Unconference 2: (Yet another) definition of reproducibility and replicability
10-13	14:00	15:25	Unconference 3: Preregistration in theory and practice – reflections from psychology and health care research
10-13	15:30	16:55	Unconference 4: Piloting transparency in ecology and evolution: current practices and ways forward
10-13	17:00	18:55	Workshop 1: Boosting collaborative research with "GitHub flow" for Rstudio
10-13	19:00	19:55	Introduction to Open Science Practices: The 'what', 'why', and 'how' of open science
10-13	20:00	21:55	Workshop 2: Is your code bug-free? Introduction to test-driven development for ecology and evolution
10-13	22:00	22:30	Break 2: Social break – languages breakout groups
10-13	22:30	23:55	Hackathon 2: Better crediting of research contributions through improved acknowledgement sections
10-14	00:00	01:55	Hackathon 3: Open science in ecology: a community hackathon on data & code transparency (cancelled)
10-14	02:00	02:55	Hackathon 4: Prodding societies in ecology and evolution towards greater equity of their membership fee structures: a meta-research protocol
10-14	03:00	03:30	Break 3: Break – Cura Vitae (self-care session)
10-14	03:30	04:55	Unconference 5: Open scholarship through the lens of ecological diversity
10-14	05:00	06:55	Workshop 3: An introduction to using docker with R for reproducible research
10-14	07:00	07:55	Hackathon 5: Exploring the fidelity of open code to methods descriptions
10-14	08:00	08:55	Plenary Talk 2: Is science open across languages?
10-14	09:00	09:15	Conference closing remarks & Awards Announcing



The unique Zoom link for the conference can be accessed [here](#)



Special session information

 [The unique Zoom link for the conference can be accessed here](#)

Conference Opening Remarks

13 October 08:00 - 08:15 UTC

Presented by: SORTEE leadership

 *Document repository:*

<https://github.com/sortee-conference/sortee-2026/tree/main/intro-concl>

Conference Closing Remarks & Awards Announcing

14 October 09:00 - 09:15 UTC

Presented by: SORTEE leadership

 *Document repository:*

<https://github.com/sortee-conference/sortee-2026/tree/main/intro-concl>

Don't miss it – the SORTEE 2026 Awards will be announced!

Introductions to Open Science Practices: The 'what', 'why', and 'how' of open science

- 13 October 08:15 - 08:55 UTC
- 13 October 19:00 - 19:55 UTC

Facilitators: SORTEE Education & Outreach Committee

 *Slack:* [#conf2026-introduction-to-open-science](#)

 *Document repository:*

<https://github.com/sortee-conference/sortee-2026/tree/main/sessions>

Topic: What is open science, why does it matter, and how can you make your work more transparent? This introductory session will provide a brief overview of key areas in open, reliable, and transparent research.

Outline: A presentation broken up into key topics (e.g., "Code and data sharing" or "Preprints"). For each, the facilitators will explain what it means, the motivation for doing it, and give links to useful resources (papers, tools like EcoEvoRxiv, Dryad, etc.)

Audience: A session dedicated to people new to open science practices but everybody is welcome to attend!

Social Breaks

 *Slack:* You can also use the Slack channel [#conference2026](#) during social breaks to chat alongside the Zoom meeting.

Social break 1: Career stages breakout groups

13 October 11:30 - 12:00 UTC



Topic: We will offer breakout rooms for different career stages (student, early-career and senior researcher), each hosted by a friendly SORTEE member. It is a great opportunity to connect, relax, and chat with people with a relatable background.

Outline: We will begin with a very short introduction to SORTEE for newcomers. Then, one breakout room will be opened for each career stage.

Social break 2: Languages breakout groups

13 October 22:00 - 22:30 UTC

Topic: The second break will offer breakout rooms in different languages, each hosted by a friendly SORTEE member. It is a great opportunity to connect, relax, and chat in your preferred language. Rooms will be available in **English, French, Portuguese, Spanish, and Japanese**.

Outline: We will begin with a very short introduction to SORTEE for newcomers. Then, one breakout room will be opened for each language.

Social break 3: Cura Vitae (Self-care session)

14 October 03:00 - 03:30 UTC

Topic: This self-care session instructs participants on how to create a simple eight page zine from an A4 piece of paper. It provides a calm environment to chat or work in companionable silence as everyone fills in their zine with doodles, writing or collage. It offers participants the opportunity to unwind and reflect on themselves as people beyond their research, in a hands-on creative way.

Outline: This session begins with a brief overview of the reflective prompts, as well as co-watching and sharing the link for the instructional video on how to make a zine, and a live demonstration. The moderator will be there to answer any questions on the process. The remainder of the session will involve filling in the zine according to the prompts, with some light conversation or working together quietly. Participants leave with their own hand-crafted zine and the knowledge to make more if they choose to do so.

Before attending: An A4 page and a pair of scissors are necessary to participate. Pens, pencils, crayons, markers, as well as spare and old newspapers/magazines with glue for collage are strongly encouraged.



Plenary information

 [The unique Zoom link for the conference can be accessed here](#)

Plenary Talk by Lauren Cadwallader: Code sharing in practice: lessons from expanding a publisher's policy

October 13, 12:00 - 12:55 UTC

Presented by: Dr. Lauren Cadwallader

 *Slack:* [#conf2026-plenary1-lauren-cadwallader](#)

 *Document repository:*

<https://github.com/sortee-conference/sortee-2026/tree/main/plenary>

Topic: In 2021 PLOS implemented a mandatory code sharing policy for its journal PLOS Computational Biology. Five years — and a lot of work later — it rolled out the policy to more journals, including PLOS Biology. This talk will explore the work needed to adapt a policy to make it suitable for disciplines that use software and code in different ways and with different levels of understanding about best practices for sharing. It will highlight differences in how researchers and editors understand code, the practical barriers to sharing in less computational fields, and the challenges of applying consistent standards across disciplines. The talk will focus on pragmatic approaches that balance reproducibility with feasibility, and on ways publishers, editors, and researchers can better support each other and set out a vision for the future of sharing open science outputs.

Outline: 40 min presentation, 20 min questions

Audience: Everyone

Plenary Talk by Tatsuya Amano: Is science open across languages

October 14, 08:00 - 08:55 UTC

Presented by: Dr. Tatsuya Amano

 *Slack:* [#conf2026-plenary2-tatsuya-amano](#)

 *Document repository:*

<https://github.com/sortee-conference/sortee-2026/tree/main/plenary>

Topic: Many barriers hinder the openness, reliability, and transparency of science. One major, yet long-overlooked barrier is language. In this presentation, I will first provide a framework, supported by case studies, for understanding how language barriers can impede science in three major ways: (1) limiting the generation of scientific knowledge by non-native English speakers, (2) constraining the global synthesis of knowledge scattered across different languages, and (3) restricting the application of English-language knowledge to local problems in countries where English is not widely spoken. I will then discuss practical solutions for overcoming language barriers in science, including both the opportunities and challenges with the use of AI.

Outline: 40 min presentation, 20 min questions

Audience: Everyone



Unconference information

Facilitated discussions of ideas for how to make ecology, evolutionary biology, and related disciplines more open, reliable, and transparent. Facilitation involves moderating the conversation with ideas and examples, but there are no formal presentations.

 [The unique Zoom link for the conference can be accessed here](#)

U01: A decade of FAIR data in ecology and evolutionary biology— but, what is FAIR?

October 13, 10:30 - 11:25 UTC

Facilitators: Anita Tarandek, Antica Čulina

 Slack: [#conf2026-u01-decade-of-fair-data-in-eco-and-evo-biology-but-what-is-fair](#)

Topic: The goal of the session is to understand to what extent machine FAIRness is necessary for human centered data use. FAIR principles are often framed in relevance to machine findability, accessibility, interoperability, and reusability, and automated tools have been developed to assess such FAIRness. Yet, much of the EcoEvo data use is more human centered. This raises important questions about how FAIRness should be assessed in practice and whether current approaches adequately reflect human FAIR data needs.

Outline: Participants will be presented with definitions and components of each letter of FAIR. In breakout groups, we will discuss which of these components are most relevant for human-centered use, and what components will be difficult to achieve in the near future for EcoEvo. This will lead to the overall discussion on whether current approaches to the FAIR principles framework adequately capture real-world reuse potential of EcoEvo datasets.

Audience: Everyone

U02: (Yet another) definition of reproducibility and replicability

October 13, 13:00 - 13:55 UTC

Facilitators: Daniel Morillo-Cuadrado, Cecilia Baldoni, Edward Ivicey-Cook

 Slack: [#conf2026-u02-yet-another-definition-of-reproducibility-and-replicability](#)

Topic: Reproducibility” and “replicability” are often used in a confusing and interchangeable way. We intend to contribute to the debate by discussing a proposal that takes into account semantic aspects of the two terms that put the spotlight on methods and results. Hopefully, this will help move the discussion forward.

Outline: We will introduce common definitions, elicit their assumed meanings, and discuss their strengths and weaknesses. Then, we will introduce these new definitions and discuss their usefulness.

- What definitions of "reproducibility" and "replicability" do you know?
- What do they refer to (methods, results, something else)?
- How do they differ and/or overlap? Are they ambiguous or confusing in some way?
- Would you use the same or different terms to refer to using a method (procedure, protocol, etc.) again and arriving at a previously reported result again? Why (not)?

Audience: Everyone



U03: Preregistration in theory and practice – reflections from psychology and health care research

October 13, 14:00 - 15:25 UTC

Facilitators: Henry Wyneken, Daniël Lakens, Hannah Grigorian, Suzanne Decker, Erin Reilly, Tristan Fletcher, Douglas Gazarian

 *Slack:* [#conf2026-u03-preregistration-in-theory-and-practice](#)

Topic: The purpose of this session is to share our experience with three common problems regarding preregistration: how to define its goals, what kinds of obstacles can prevent its implementation and how deviations from the preregistration are handled.

Outline: We want to share our experience advocating for and using preregistration in our fields (psychology and health care research). The first talk (Lakens) argues that preregistration should have a focused goal, which is to clearly communicate the severity of a study's results. The second talk (Fletcher and Gazarian) will discuss their experience preregistering a quality improvement study. The third talk (Reilly, Decker and Grigorian) will discuss how aspects of clinical trials (e.g. sensitive populations, multi-site studies) complicate preregistration. The final presentation (Wyneken) discusses how preregistering an RCT helped justify stopping the experiment early for efficacy.

Audience: Everyone

U04: Piloting transparency in ecology and evolution: current practices and ways forward

October 13, 15:30 - 16:55 UTC

Facilitators: Alfredo Sánchez-Tójar, Agata Bochynska, Mary Beth Neff

 *Slack:* [#conf2026-u04-piloting-transparency-in-ecology-and-evolution](#)

Topic: Pilot studies are a critical yet often overlooked part of the research process. Methods, tools, and analytical choices are frequently developed and refined during this phase, but pilots are rarely reported in publications or other research outputs. Greater transparency around pilot studies would help make the full life cycle of the research process more visible and reproducible. In this unconference, we will explore current piloting practices in ecology and evolution, drawing on participants' own experiences and perspectives on reporting pilot studies. Building on previous work on transparency in piloting in psychology ([Pilot Reporting Task Force, 2024](#)), we will adapt an existing survey on piloting practices for an ecology and evolution audience prior to the unconference.

Outline: During the session, we will introduce the topic, invite participants to complete the preliminary version of the survey, and facilitate a roundtable discussion with two guests on its fit for ecology and any adjustments needed. We will also circulate an Expression of Interest for those wishing to contribute to the broader project moving forward.

Audience: Everyone



U05: Open scholarship through the lens of ecological diversity

October 14, 03:30-04:55 UTC

Facilitators: Gracielle Higinio

 *Slack:* [#conf2026-u05-open-scholarship-through-the-lens-of-ecological-diversity](#)

Topic: This unconference discusses how and if we can use ecological diversity metrics to help us understand states of open scholarship culture.

Outline: We will discuss whether components of ecological diversity metrics (richness, evenness, turnover) can inspire ways to describe openness in research. Prompts include: what are meaningful dimensions of open science? Can they be measured or compared without oversimplification? Where does the ecological analogy break down? The goal is to map candidate metrics, identify shared definitions, and outline potential empirical or conceptual follow-up work.

Audience: Everyone



Hackathon information

Group projects with well-defined goals (papers, techniques, software, protocols, organizations etc.).



[The unique Zoom link for the conference can be accessed here](#)

H01: How does data and code policy impact quality of data and code sharing in society journals?

October 13 09:00 - 10:25 UTC

Facilitators: Edward Ivimey-Cook, Joel Pick



Slack: [#conf2026-h01-how-data-code-policy-impact-data-quality-code-sharing-in-journals](#)

Topic: Assess the data and code availability and quality from 93 society journals across EcoEvo to see if mandates/data editors influence open data and code.

Outline: Participants will be given a subset of papers from the 93 journals. They will be asked to rate the availability and quality of the data and code and fill in a Google form. After the conference, participants will have the opportunity to get involved in the project. The ultimate goal would be to write a manuscript for publication, and participants will be invited to the co-authors list, if applicable.

Audience: Everyone, but some knowledge of data and code would be useful.

H02: Better crediting of research contributions through improved acknowledgment sections

October 13 22:30 - 22:55 UTC

Facilitators: Alex Holcombe, Malgorzata (Losia) Lagisz, Erika M. Santana



Slack: [#conf2026-h02-better-crediting-of-research-contribution](#)

Topic: Ecology and evolution research has a very diverse range of contribution types and contributors with many levels of contributions, ranging from principal investigators to citizen scientists and local field workers. This hackathon will focus on the relatively-neglected topic of acknowledgment practices. First, we will lay out the problems pointed to and recommendations for improving acknowledgment sections proposed by recent publications ([Holcombe et Lagisz et al., Accountability in Research, 2026](#)). The results provided by an unpublished analysis of the most frequently-acknowledged types of contributions mentioned in the acknowledgments of ecology and evolution journals (Kovacs et al., unpublished) will stimulate this hackathon's discussion of how to tailor the recommendations to the EcoEvo community. .

Outline: We will brainstorm on how to advocate reforms to individual researchers in EcoEvo, societies, journals, and publishers, which concrete steps should be emphasized, and the best ways to reach them. Using blogposts we have written for other audiences as a starting point, we will lead the outlining and writing of one or more blogpost-type articles to communicate to one or more of these audiences. We will simultaneously draw up a list of venues to promote these articles to.

Audience: No specialist skills are required. The topic is accessible to researchers at all career stages globally and particularly relevant to individuals interested in equity, diversity, inclusion, open science, academic societies, and meta-research.



H03 (Cancelled): Open science in ecology: a community hackathon on data & code transparency

October 14 00:00 - 01:55 UTC

Facilitators: Bruno Soares

⚠ This hackathon has been cancelled ⚠

H04: Prodding societies in ecology and evolution towards greater equity of their membership fee structures: a meta-research protocol

October 14 02:00 - 02:55 UTC

Facilitators: Marija Purgar, Malgorzata (Losia) Lagisz

🌐 *Slack:* [#conf2026-h04-prodding-societies-in-eco-and-evo-towards-memership-fee-equity](#)

Topic: This hackathon focuses on launching an open, collaborative project to evaluate whether international learned societies in ecology and evolutionary biology have adopted more equitable membership fee structures following the earlier SORTEE project and publication by [Lagisz et al. \(2025\)](#): *Priced Out of Belonging? Insufficient Concessions on Membership Fees Across International Societies in Ecology and Evolution*. The goal of this project is to collect updated information on membership fee structures, concessions, waivers, and equity-related policies across learned societies and assess whether meaningful changes have occurred since the original survey. We will explore whether societies that were contacted about the study or publicly engaged with its findings were more likely to implement equitable membership practices.

Outline: We will use online forms to gather Expressions of Interest from attendees who wish to join this collaborative meta-research initiative. During the hackathon, participants will help refine data extraction procedures, identify candidate societies for inclusion, discuss definitions of equitable fee structures, and pilot-test the data collection workflow.

Audience: No specialist skills are required. The topic is accessible to researchers at all career stages globally and particularly relevant to individuals interested in equity, diversity, inclusion, open science, academic societies, and meta-research. We especially welcome participants with diverse linguistic backgrounds, since some local societies maintain online presences exclusively in non-English languages.

H05: Exploring the fidelity of open code to methods descriptions

October 14 07:00 - 07:55 UTC

Facilitators: Saras Windecker, Rob Moss, Edward Ivimey-Cook

🌐 *Slack:* [#conf2026-h05-exploring-the-fidelity-of-open-code-to-method-descriptions](#)

Topic: The aim of this hackathon will be to explore the concept of fidelity of open code — which we define as how completely and accurately open code matches methods as described. We will be building upon previous work that has focused on availability and accessibility of open code.



Outline: During the hackathon session, we will spend the first 10-15 minutes outlining the protocol. Participants will then examine fidelity of open code in a subset of research papers identified in the [Methods in Ecology and Evolution open data hackathon](#) having open and accessible code (~500). Ideally, participants will then split into pairs to practice on a paper and provide feedback in the session on what elements will need to be revised. A Google Form will allow to collect information from the papers, and another spreadsheet will be used to collect participant information.

Audience: This exercise is designed to allow participation from people who can interpret code as well as those who are less experienced at doing so. Active participation in data extraction will require familiarity with code and ecological models, but the discussion and planning components are accessible to a wider audience. The session will not involve running code.



Workshop information

Facilitators will teach tools for implementing open, reliable, and transparent practices.

 [The unique Zoom link for the conference can be accessed here](#)

W01: Boosting collaborative research with "GitHub flow" for Rstudio users

October 13 17:00 - 18:55 UTC

Facilitators: Daniel Morillo-Cuadrado

 Slack: [#conf2026-w01-boosting-collaborative-research-with-github-flow-for-rstudio](#)

Topic: This workshop is an introduction to "GitHub flow", a workflow for seamless and effective collaboration. Participants will come out with a mental model of the GitHub flow, and will be able to collaborate by implementing the critical steps of this workflow: create a branch, commit + push changes, create a Pull Request, review and approve a Pull Request, and merge the Pull Request.

Outline:

- Brief introduction to "GitHub flow".
- Hands-on implementation of a "GitHub flow cycle":
 - Authoring a Pull Request
 - Reviewing changes
 - Merging changes
- Concluding remarks & discussion

Before attending:

- Make sure you have:
 - R, Rstudio, and the Git client installed locally (use the latest available versions).
 - a GitHub account and are logged in with your default browser.
 - a public GitHub repository that you can experiment with during the workshop.
 - the repository cloned locally.
 - (optionally) a script or document (Quarto, Rmarkdown, Jupyter...) you want to work with during the workshop (that is NOT already in the repository).

Audience: Participants must be familiar with RStudio, using it either for scientific computing (in R or Python) or for scientific writing (in Quarto, Rmarkdown, Jupyter, etc.). They must also have a GitHub account, be able to create a repository and clone it locally, and be familiar with the "pull - change - commit - push" workflow. They should also have the need to use GitHub collaboratively with colleagues, e.g., by finding themselves sharing scripts or rendered Quarto documents by email or shared folders, and receiving comments in docx files. Participants should not know what GitHub flow is. They may know what git branching is, but feel unconfident creating branches, or do not know what their intended use is. They may also know what a Pull Request is, but do not feel proficient with them.



W02: Is your code bug-free? Introduction to test-driven development for ecology and evolution

October 13 20:00 - 21:55 UTC

Facilitators: Raphaël Scherrer

 [Slack: #conf2026-w02-introduction-to-test-driven-development-for-ecology-and-evolution](#)

Topic: Test-driven development (TDD) is a programming philosophy which helps avoid bugs in your code. Widely used in the software industry, it remains underused among scientists. In this workshop, participants will learn what TDD is and how to implement it in their own research to produce more reliable code.

Outline: The workshop includes a small lecture and a practical. The lecture will focus on code reliability in ecology and evolution, and introduce concepts such as unit tests and code coverage. In the practical, you will build a small project in either R or Python, writing your own unit tests to check for bugs. If all your tests pass and cover 100% of your code, you have completed the practical!

Before attending: You can choose to follow the practical in either R or Python, and so it is best if either engine is already installed on your computer. For R, we will be making use of the RStudio editor. For Python, we will be using pip to install non-standard dependencies. It would be best if the necessary libraries and programs are already installed prior to the session; but we can also troubleshoot installation issues during the session if needed. More detailed instructions will be made available through an online repository.

Audience: This course covers a relatively advanced programming practice, and so requires solid coding bases and familiarity with R or Python. If you know how to write functions in either language, with multiple arguments, for-loops, and if-statements, you should be all set. Knowing how to make an R package is a plus, but not a requirement. This workshop is most useful if your work involves writing reusable functions for custom analyses, developing packages and libraries for other people to use, or building simulations. It is less relevant if you mostly write one-off scripts for analyzing datasets or making plots, or if you mostly run bioinformatics pipelines from a command line.

W04: An introduction to using Docker with R for reproducible research

October 14 05:00 - 06:55 UTC

Facilitators: Steven Kambouris

 [Slack: #conf2026-w03-an-introduction-to-using-docker-with-r-for-reproducible-research](#)

Topic: This workshop is designed to help you get started with one approach to setting up reproducible computational environments for R analyses: using containers with Docker. It will introduce useful tools and projects (Binder, the Rocker Project) for running different versions of R in containers, and cover how to locate and install different versions of R packages in containers. The goal of the workshop is to gain some hands-on experience with simple working examples which you can then adapt for your own analyses.

Outline: The session will start with an overview of why we might want to use containers for computational reproducibility, followed by a brief overview of containers and Docker. The workshop will proceed with an on-screen demonstration of setting up, running, and stopping containers to conduct an example analysis in R, with explanations of the steps involved. Participants will have the opportunity to replicate the steps on their own machines, and ask questions about using the tools.



Before attending: Workshop attendees wishing to run containers on their local computers will want to download and install Docker Desktop for Windows, Mac or Linux. Note that a paid Docker plan is not required. Windows users note that installation of Docker Desktop on Windows may require the additional installation of the Windows Subsystem for Linux (WSL) and a Linux distribution. Attendees who cannot or do not wish to install Docker will be able to participate in some parts of the workshop using binder (<https://mybinder.org/>) and GitHub.

Audience: This workshop assumes experience with using R, including installing packages. Familiarity with git and GitHub is also required (to clone repositories from GitHub).



Sponsors

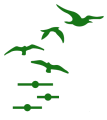
The Society for Open, Reliable, and Transparent Ecology and Evolutionary Biology (SORTEE) 6th annual conference is made possible through the ongoing support and collaboration of organizations that share our vision for greater openness and transparency in science.

We are deeply grateful to our sponsors, including [Canadian Science Publishing](#), [Dryad](#), [Peer Community In](#), [The Royal Society Publishing](#), [Society for the Study of Evolution](#), [The Company of Biologists](#), and [Physalia courses](#), and whose financial contributions have helped bring this conference to life.

Thank you for standing with us as we continue to work towards a more open and reliable future for scientific research in Ecology and Evolutionary Biology.

(Listed in no particular order)





Thank you!

We want to extend a heartfelt thank you to all the incredible presenters, facilitators, and attendees who made the SORTEE 2026 conference a success.

We couldn't have done it without you - our sincere appreciation and cheers to every one of you!

The 2026 SORTEE Conference Committee

Stephanie Flaman (Chair)

Juliette Tariel-Adam

Abuoma Ejikeme

Magdalena Wutkowska

Lara Hinnerger

Lise Layotte

Lisa Nicvert

Munyaneza Aphrodis